

and then retired to the living room, where he read, sometimes business materials but usually library murder mysteries— until bedtime. When I was a child, he would take a break at our bed-time to tell my brothers and me bedtime stories, which he lavished on us—more on me than on my brothers because I liked them better. Sometimes they were non-fiction history about heroic figures or events, like Joan of Arc, the American Revolution, Paul Revere's ride, the life of Napoleon. Others were fiction of his own creation, something he hoped eventually to turn into children's books but never did. They were all great. My brothers and I had separate bedrooms, and Father would sit on the bed's edge of whomever he was telling the story to. One or more of us would lie on the floor nearby, and when we fell asleep, he carried us to bed. He and mother went to bed about ten. In the morning, he drove us kids to school at 7:30 in a beat-up old blue Oldsmobile and drove on to a point a half mile from San Mateo's train station. He walked to the station and rode the rails into San Francisco. Early-morning San Mateo retailers came to call him “the flash” because he walked so fast, leaning forward in a world long before “power walking.” He believed that if rain wasn't hard, it did no good, and that if walking wasn't fast, it was a waste of mileage. He loved the railroad train and had been riding trains since childhood. His morning train departed at 8:00. It arrived at the San Francisco depot at Third and Townsend Streets at 8:30 (a block from its current location). On the train he read business materials, every day. If someone approached him to talk, he told them he was busy working, which he was, and then kept reading. Cool. Solitary. He then walked a mile to his office in Mills Tower at the corner of Bush and San- some Streets. If someone wanted to walk with him, they couldn't because he walked so fast that they couldn't keep up. Cool. Solitary. A sort of gunslinger of his own creation. At Mills Tower, he took the elevator to the eighteenth floor and entered his office. Alone. Actually, he had two offices over the years. He was at suite 1810 from World War II until 1970, when he moved to suite 1820. The pictures on the back cover of the dust jacket of *Conservative Investors Sleep Well* were in both offices, and they sit today on the wall of a conference room at my corporate headquarters.

His furniture never changed all those years. Same desk, which now sits in my old childhood bedroom. Chairs, and every form of appointment—none of it changed for forty years and was all Spartan. He was Spartan. His luxury there? The view of San Francisco Bay. When he moved to 1820, he